Building and Serving in High Performance Teams



Casey Ayers

MBA • PMP® • CBAP®

@caseyayers | www.study.pm



Project Leaders in Agile Environments

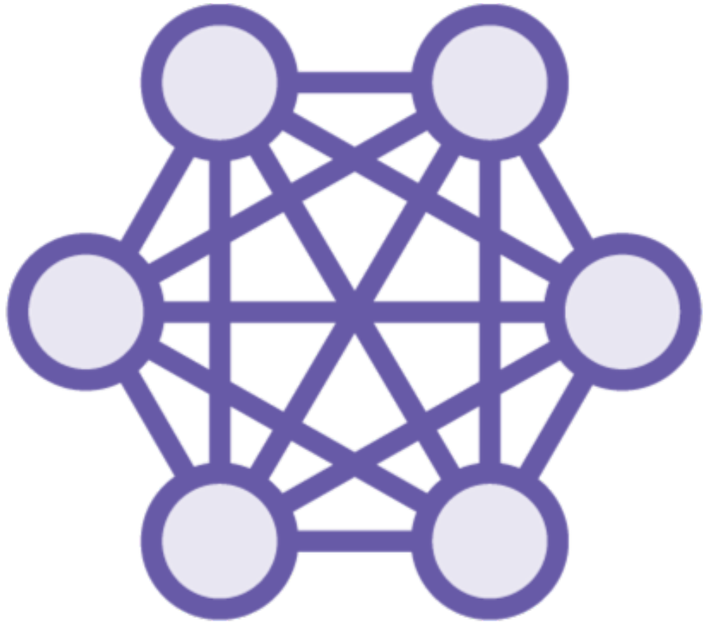
Understanding Agile Team Motivation





Characteristics of High Performance Teams & Leaders

Agile Team Organization





Agile Team Communication

Project Leaders in Agile Environments

Ideal Project Manager



Master tactician

Wildly popular

Optimization wizard



The best project manager is only as effective as their least productive team member



The best project manager is only as effective as their least productive team member

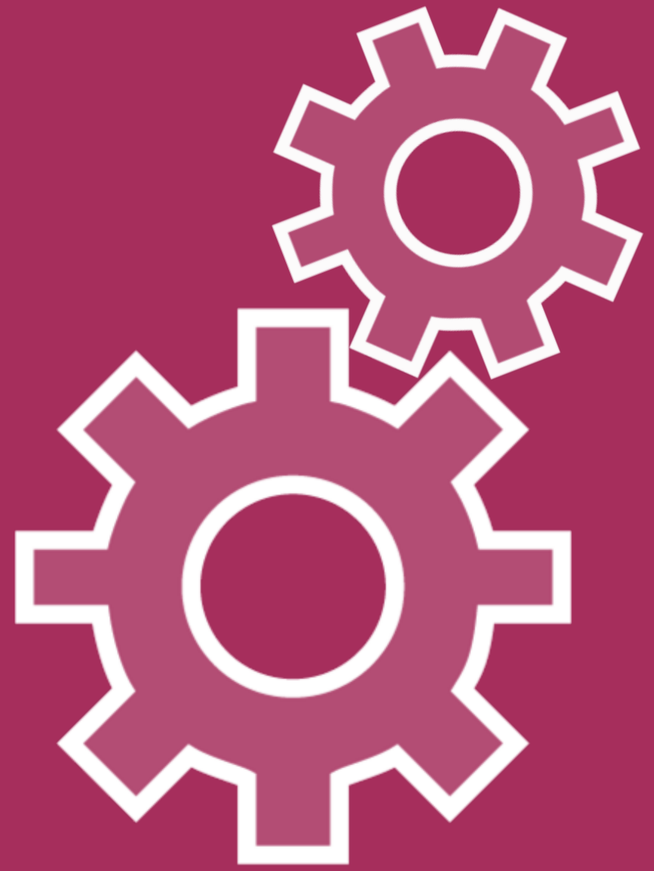


Agile projects accept the limitations of project leaders and recognize the criticality of strong teams



Projects bold in vision and valuable in scope rely on more than one contributor

Team members must be more than cogs in a machine



Understanding Agile Team Motivation



Build around motivated individuals

Theory Y
Intrinsic Motivation





Theory X
Extrinsic Motivation

Build Around Motivated Individuals



Share vision with stakeholders



Align talents and challenges



Focus on results, not process

Characteristics of High Performance Teams & Leaders

“Responsibilities are fixed, but the work of the project is everyone’s work…the only important distinctions have to do with competence and not position.”

Lawrence V. Suda

Suda, L. V. (2015). Developing superior project teams at NASA. Paper presented at PMI® Global Congress 2015—North America, Orlando, FL. Newtown Square, PA: Project Management Institute.

NASA Team Characteristics



Mission focus and commitment to success



Communication across boundaries



Interdependence and team cohesion



Recognition and empowerment

Suda, L. V. (2015). Developing superior project teams at NASA. Paper presented at PMI® Global Congress 2015—North America, Orlando, FL. Newtown Square, PA: Project Management Institute.

NASA Leader Characteristics



Shields team members from distractions



Ensures team has resources needed



Fosters team cohesion and commitment

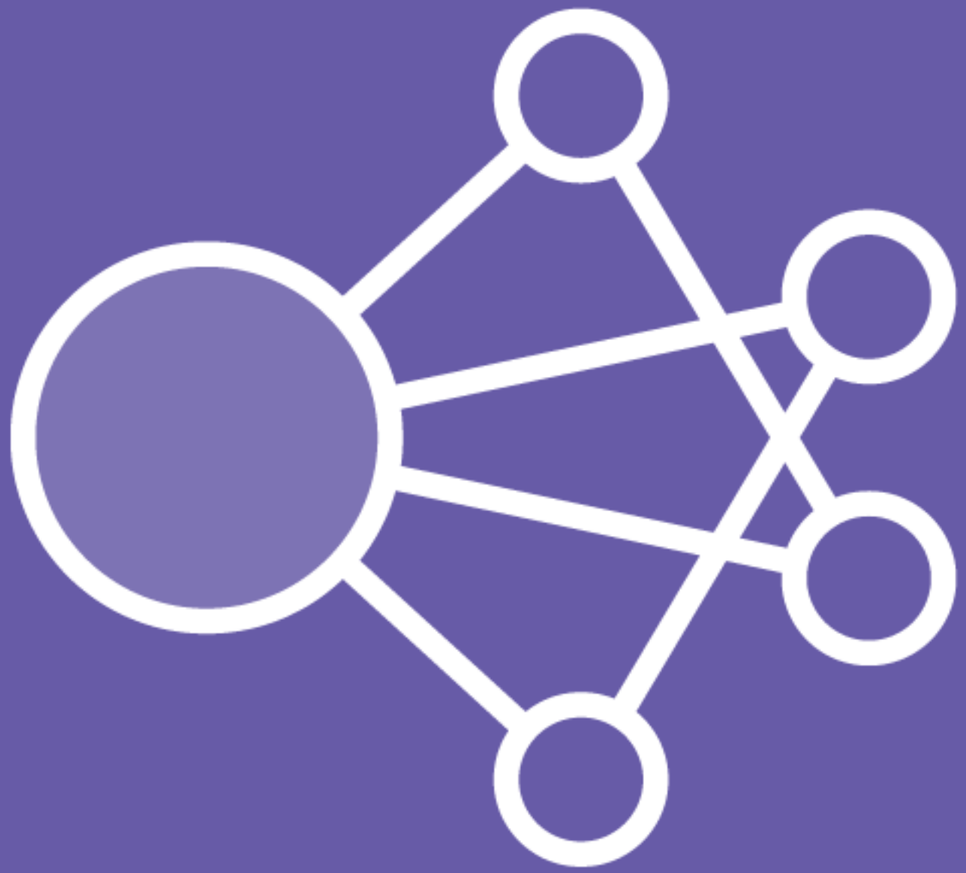


Models desirable attributes

Suda, L. V. (2015). Developing superior project teams at NASA. Paper presented at PMI® Global Congress 2015—North America, Orlando, FL. Newtown Square, PA: Project Management Institute.

Agile Team Organization

Self-organize for success



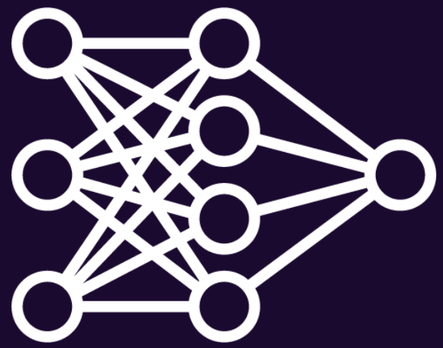
Self-organize for Success



Share your talents and learn from others



Use retrospectives wisely



Adapt organically to meet challenges

Self-organize for Success



Avoid siloing; proactively mix collaborations



Equal platform for all, regardless of experience



Use critical thinking to guide next steps

Agile Team Communication



Value face to face communication

Value Face to Face Communication



Check in regularly



Bring remote teams together when merited



Leverage video when in-person meetings are impractical



Takeaways

Agile projects require a greater degree of involvement by all stakeholders

Individual motivation coupled with a sense of shared mission leads to highly collaborative teams



Takeaways

Team members must exhibit a sense of ownership over their work

Leaders must focus on clearing obstacles, not simply directing project work



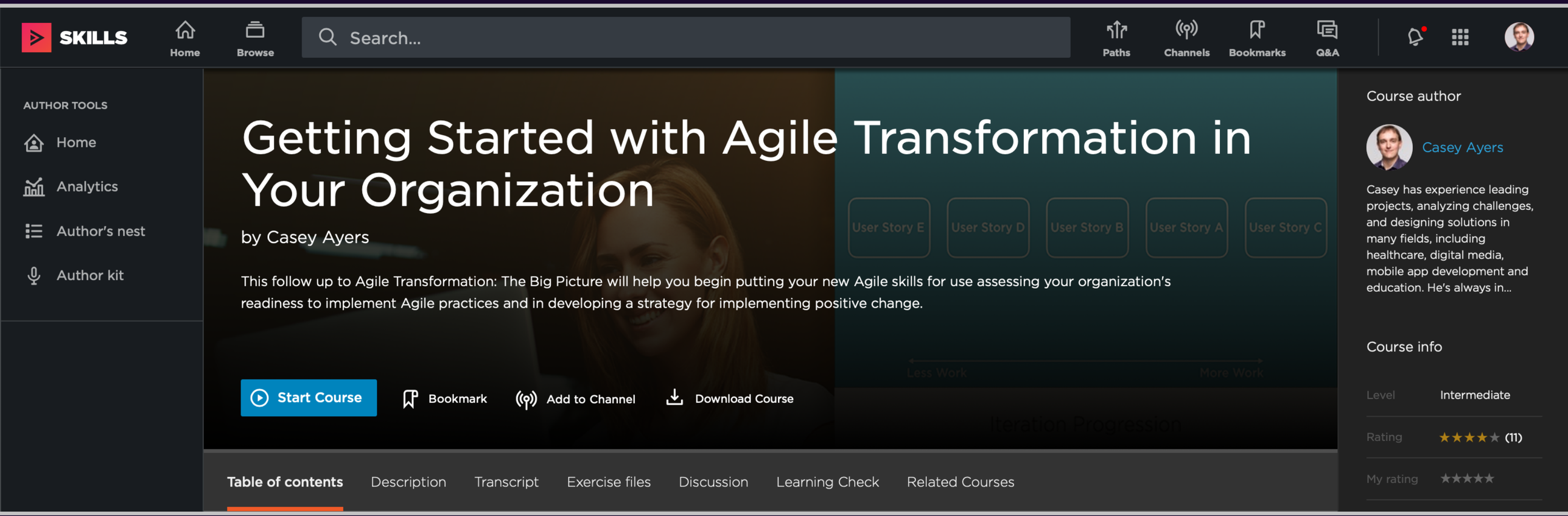
Takeaways

Effective Agile teams self-organize, and reallocate resources regularly

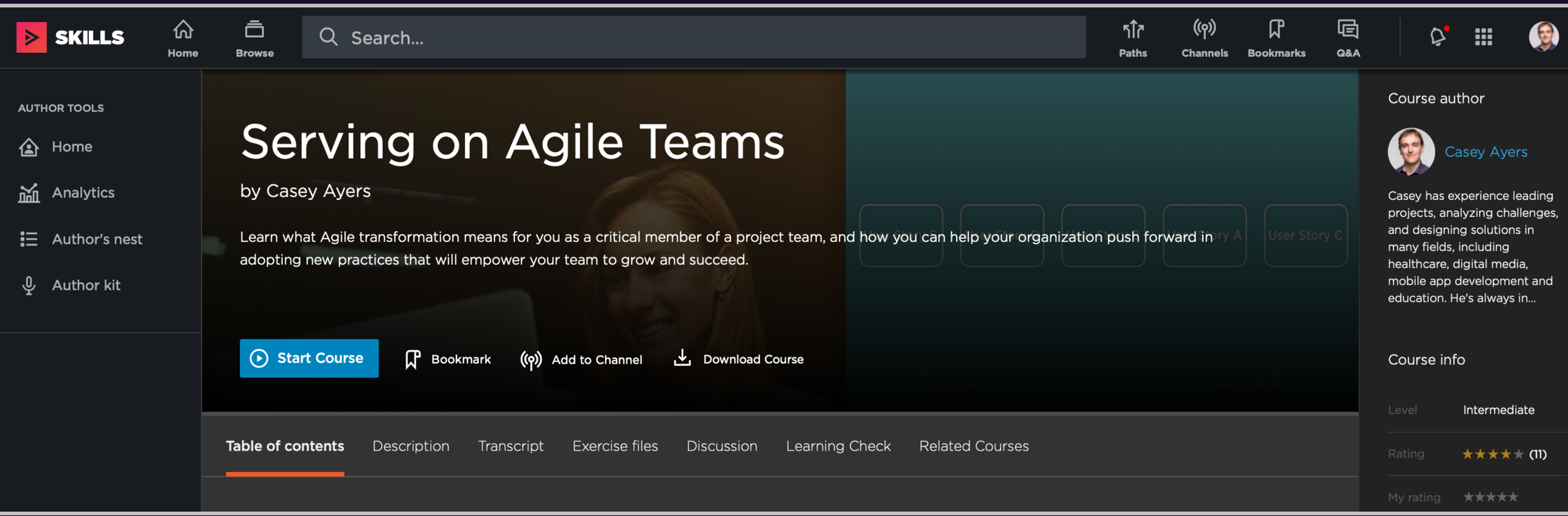
Face to face communication is preferable when possible to enhance collaboration

Remote work requires special attention be paid to maintaining lines of communication and fostering a sense of community across the team

Continue Learning:



Continue Learning:





Congratulations!